

Drag your 3.5" disk icon to the Trash. More specifically, position the pointer on top of the 3.5" disk icon and press the mouse button. Hold the mouse button while you drag the mouse to the Trash icon—an outline of the 3.5" disk icon will follow the pointer. Position the pointer on top of the Trash icon. Make sure the Trash icon has turned black (if it hasn't, your pointer isn't in the right place) and release the mouse button.

If you did things right, your 3.5" disk drive whirled and spat out the disk. The disk should now be gone from the desktop. (If you ejected the disk you started up from, a "shadow" of the disk will remain on the desktop—you can't permanently eject your startup disk.) For now, just put the disk back in the drive and the 3.5" disk icon will reappear.

Other disk icons can be dragged to the Trash, too. For example, if you're on an AppleShare network, you can drag a shared volume icon to the Trash to unmount it. You can also use the Trash to make the Finder forget about the disk in a 5.25" drive—just drag the 5.25" disk icon to the trash. You can't put hard drives, RAM Disks, or most other disks in the Trash—only disks with removable media and network disks can be "ejected" or "unmounted" this way.

The Trash is used for removing icons from the Finder desktop. In the case of disks, as we've seen, this means ejecting them or unmounting them. Dragging files and folders to the trash, on the other hand, actually removes them from the disk they're on. We'll get to that later, though.

NB

Coloring Icons

The Finder also allows you to color your black-and-white icons (such as the Trash). For this example, we'll color the Trash green, like one of those big industrial trash barrels. Just click the icon, and then pull down the color menu. Choose the medium green (in the middle of the third column) and release the mouse button. The trash can will instantly turn green. In effect, the Color menu changes the *white* in the icon to whatever color you choose.

You can also color an icon's outline (the black lines in the icon). Let's try that. Click the Trash again. Now press the Control key and hold it down while you select the desired color from the menu—let's try the yellow at the bottom of the second column. Release the mouse button and your Trash icon appears green with yellow highlights.

Note!

When you color an icon or its outline, the Finder automatically unselects it. (If it remained black, you wouldn't be able to see the change you made.)

The Finder cannot color icons that already contain colors. For example, you can't color your hard drive icons, since they contain gray and red; you can't color RAM Disk icons, since they contain green and yellow; you can't even color 3.5" disk icons, since they contain gray. In fact, the only icon on a normal desktop that you *can* color is the Trash. You can, however, color most application, document, and folder icons, which is a tremendous aid in keeping your disks organized and easy to use.